

## **Mazin Ahmed**

**Product Security, Offensive Security, and Security Research**

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### **Profile**

12+ years in product security engineering, offensive security, and program leadership. Joined Chime as an early security engineer and helped build and scale product-security, offensive-security, and vulnerability-management capabilities through Chime's growth into a public-company environment. Founded and built FullHunt.io, an internet-scale ASM platform. Led M&A security programs, application security threat modeling, AI security governance, company-wide controls, and bug bounty operations. Reported critical vulnerabilities to the U.S. Department of Defense, Microsoft, Meta, X / Twitter, Oracle, and LinkedIn. CISA recommended my Log4Shell scanner for US government scanning. Speaks at BlackHat MEA, DEFCON, Hack In The Box, Swiss Cyber Storm, and OWASP chapters. Focuses on building security capabilities, researching new attack vectors, eliminating vulnerability classes, and translating technical risk into product and business outcomes.

### **Technical Specialties**

- Offensive security experience: penetration testing and red-team operations, and vulnerability research
- Cloud security (Amazon AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure)
- Security program building and scaling
- AI/LLM security, safety, and governance
- Security automation engineering at scale
- Web and Mobile application security

### **Key Achievements**

- Joined Chime as one of the first security engineers; helped scale the security program through IPO.
- Founded and built FullHunt.io, an internet-wide scanning platform that is used by thousands of security researchers and teams for discovering exposure and remote vulnerabilities.
- Built log4j-scan during the Log4Shell wave; CISA recommended it for US government scanning.
- Led Namshi's security program through the Emaar acquisition.
- Wrote security tools that are used by thousands of security professionals around the world.
- Holds a number of registered CVEs for reporting security vulnerabilities, such as: CVE-2014-9414, CVE-2017-7320, CVE-2017-7321, CVE-2017-7322, CVE-2017-7323, and CVE-2017-7324.
- Conducted research on the CVE-2014-9414 vulnerability, where it was nominated for the Pwnie Awards of 2015 for the "Best Client-Side bug of 2015".
- Ranked in the top 10 security researchers of Bugcrowd in 2014.
- Have spoken in security conferences, including BlackHat MEA, DEFCON, HITB, OPCDE, and SwissCyberStorm.

## **Experience**

### **Senior Application Security Engineer II at Chime**

July 2020 - Present

Joined as an early security engineer and helped build and scale product-security, offensive-security, and vulnerability-management capabilities across the engineering organization. Led initiatives focused on building security controls, vulnerability research and discovery, penetration testing, red-team operations, threat modeling, M&A security integration, bug bounty operations, and security automation through Chime's growth into a public-company environment.

Key initiatives: GraphQL security, AI security research, M&A security integration, AWS security controls, GCP infrastructure security, Terraform security, bug bounty operations, vulnerability research, supply chain controls, container security, secrets detection and prevention.

### **Security Consultant at Namshi (Emaar-acquired company)**

March 2019 – March 2020

- Developed the company's security program.
- Was responsible for engineering and compliance projects after the Emaar acquisition.
- Worked in establishing DevSecOps within the company.

### **Security Consultant at ProtonMail**

July 2017 – January 2019

- Worked at the ProtonMail security engineering team.
- Conducted frequent security audits on the company's applications.
- Developed security and threat-intelligence projects for ProtonMail.
- Was responsible for managing the ProtonMail bug bounty program.

### **Founder at FullHunt.io**

December 2016 – Present

Built an internet-scale ASM platform for external attack-surface discovery, monitoring, and scanning. Led R&D for internet-wide network scanning and global attack-surface discovery algorithms.

### **Security Researcher at Bugcrowd Inc**

December 2013 – March 2017

- Identified security vulnerabilities in companies and organizations, and conducted responsible disclosure to vendors.
- Ranked in the top 10 security researchers of Bugcrowd in 2014.

### **Independent Security Researcher at Bug Bounty Programs**

December 2013 – March 2017

- Participated in numerous bug bounty programs.
- Identified severe security vulnerabilities in major companies, such as: Facebook, Twitter, Oracle, and LinkedIn to name a few.

## **Penetration Tester at Defensive Security**

April 2014 – October 2014

- Provided penetration testing services focused on web application security.
- Performed advanced penetration tests to major companies and organizations.

## **Volunteer Experience**

### **Security Contributor - Member of ProtonMail's Security Group at ProtonMail**

July 2014 - July 2017

Was an active contributor to ProtonMail, the world's top end-to-end encrypted email service. Provided security assessments for ProtonMail builds, contributed security feedback on product changes, and helped identify weaknesses before release.

## **Selected Public Projects**

- **FullHunt.io / FullHunt ASM**: External attack-surface discovery, monitoring, and scanning platform; public asset database/community search engine.
- **secrets-patterns-db**: Large open-source regex database for detecting secrets, API keys, passwords, tokens, and related sensitive patterns.
- **Shennina**: AI-driven automated host exploitation framework using A3C Reinforcement Learning. HITB AI Challenge finalist project.
- **log4j-scan**: Scanner for Log4Shell / CVE-2021-44228, publicly recommended by CISA for Log4Shell scanning.
- **tfquery**: Framework for running SQL queries on Terraform code and plans.
- **Stressful.io**: Cloud-based DDoS simulation/stress-testing engine with 20+ DoS modules.
- **protonvpn-cli**: Official ProtonVPN command-line tool for Linux and macOS.
- **Phish-Catcher**: Client-side Node.js phishing-email detection library based on modular checks.
- **llmquery**: Framework for interacting with LLM APIs using reusable YAML prompt templates, validations, provider integrations, and structured outputs.
- **xless**: Serverless blind XSS detection tool.

## **Conference Talks**

- Compromising Developers with Malicious Extensions - Black Hat MEA (2025)
- Attacking GraphQL APIs - OWASP PNW / Vancouver (2024)
- DoS Attacks are Dead: Demystifying Practical DoS Attacks - Black Hat MEA (2022)
- Attack Vectors on Terraform Environments - DEF CON Cloud Village (2021)
- Hacking Zoom: Uncovering Tales of Security Vulnerabilities in Zoom - DEF CON Red Team Village (2020) —
- Practical Approaches for Testing and Breaking JWT Authentication - Hack in the Box Abu Dhabi (2019)
- Bug Bounty Hunting for Companies and Researchers - Swiss Cyber Storm (2016)

## **Honors and Awards**

### **U.S Department of Defense – Security Acknowledgment**

U.S Department of Defense

Responsibly disclosed several severe vulnerabilities in the U.S Department of Defense systems. Vulnerabilities have been acknowledged and patched by the Department of Defense.

<https://hackerone.com/reports/195544>

### **Meta Whitehat**

Meta

Reported a Cross-Site Scripting vulnerability on one of Meta's services.

<https://www.facebook.com/whitehat/thanks>

### **Twitter Security Acknowledgement**

Twitter

Reported multiple critical vulnerabilities responsibly to Twitter Security.

<https://hackerone.com/twitter/thanks>

### **Oracle Security Acknowledgement**

Oracle

Responsibly disclosed a critical XSS on one of Oracle's services.

<http://www.oracle.com/ocom/groups/public/@otn/documents/webcontent/2188432.xml>

### **Hack In The Box 2019 – AI Competition - Finalist**

Hack in The Box

Hack in the Box (HITB) AI competition is a 2 months-duration competition where companies and universities compete in building an offensive security project that utilizes Artificial Intelligence in performing target exploitation. Our team reached the finals for our project, Shennina, a fully-automated host exploitation and post-exploitation tool that uses AI for predicting the best exploit against the target.

### **Pwnie Awards – Best Client-side Bug of 2015 – Nominee**

Pwnie Awards

The finding of CVE-2014-9414, W3 Total Cache CSRF that leads to total defacements of websites has been nominated for the best client-side bug of 2015 in Pwnie Awards. The award is given to the person who discovered or exploited the most technically sophisticated and interesting client-side bug.

<http://pwnies.com>

### **Top Ten Web Hacking Techniques of 2015 – 4th Place**

Top Web Hacking Techniques Award

The research of “Evading All Web-Application Firewalls XSS Filters” has received the fourth place on Top Web Hacking Techniques of 2015 award. The award is given to acknowledge and reward the hard work of the most influential researches done by security researchers.

<http://www.darkreading.com/endpoint/top-10-web-hacking-techniques-for-2015-/d-id/1325281>

<https://www.whitehatsec.com/blog/top-10-web-hacking-techniques-of-2015/>

### **ABN AMRO Bank Security Acknowledgement**

ABN AMRO Group

Reported multiple critical vulnerabilities on ABN AMRO Bank online services.

### **Sudanese Higher-Education Championship 2017 - 1st Place**

Ministry of Higher-Education – Sudan

Won 1st place in the Sudanese Higher-Education Championship.

### **LinkedIn Security Acknowledgement**

LinkedIn

Reported multiple critical security vulnerabilities on LinkedIn services.

### **Mozilla Hall of Fame - Q4 2014**

The Mozilla Foundation

Discovered a critical security vulnerability on Mozilla blog that could allow a full defacement of Mozilla blog via an exploit I previously wrote.

<https://www.mozilla.org/en-US/security/bug-bounty/web-hall-of-fame/>

### **ProtonMail's Hackathon 2nd Place**

ProtonMail

I got second place in ProtonMail's first hackathon in August 2014. I have also earned the "Artisan" award for performing the most creative attack resulting in a bug found, and "Shotgun" award for disclosing the most amount of bugs.

<https://protonmail.ch/hackathon/>

### **Adobe Security Competition Winner**

Adobe

Adobe made a private security competition in May 2015. It was made with the partnership of Bugcrowd platform. I have won 3rd place in the competition.

### **Ebay Security Acknowledgement**

Ebay

Reported various vulnerabilities on Ebay's services and Magneto Web-App.

<http://ebay.com/securitycenter/ResearchersAcknowledgement.html>

### **Yandex Security Acknowledgement**

Yandex

Acknowledged by Yandex for reporting security issues on their DNS implementations.

<https://yandex.com/bugbounty/hall-of-fame/2016/6/>

### **Symantec Wall of Fame**

Symantec

Responsibly disclosed a number of security vulnerabilities that affected Symantec web services.

<https://www.symantec.com/connect/pages/security-researcher-wall-fame>

## **Sony Hall of Fame**

Sony

Reported a security issue that affected one of Sony's services.

<https://secure.sony.net/hallofthanks>

## **ESET Security Acknowledgement**

ESET

Received an acknowledgment from ESET for reporting security vulnerabilities that affect one of their services.

[https://mazinahmed.net/uploads/files/ESET\\_Acknowledgement.png](https://mazinahmed.net/uploads/files/ESET_Acknowledgement.png)

## **Languages**

**Arabic**

(Native proficiency)

**English**

(Professional proficiency)

## **Education**

### **Future University – Bachelor of Computer Science**

2015 – 2019

- Studied a Computer Science bachelor program.
- Represented the university in local technology competitions.
- Obtained a full scholarship based on security research and technical work.

### **SMA Secondary School**

2014 – 2015

Obtained a secondary education diploma.

### **St. Catharine's Collegiate**

2013 – 2014

### **Code Academy**

2012 – 2014

Web-Development Languages.

## **Interests**

Mixed Martial Arts, Olympic Wrestling, Hiking, Soccer, Badminton, Traveling.

## **References**

Available upon request.

## **Public Links**

- Personal site: <https://mazinahmed.net>
- GitHub: <https://github.com/mazen160>
- Projects and research: <https://mazinahmed.net/projects/>
- Honors and awards: <https://mazinahmed.net/awards/>
- Press and citations: <https://mazinahmed.net/press/>
- LinkedIn: <https://linkedin.com/in/infosecmazinahmed>